

shows without a huge cable package. Each program requires its own subscription fee, as well as gear to connect it to your TV, but the cost is so minor compared to the average cable bill that it's worth exploring.

Here's a quick breakdown of these services and what they offer:

- **Netflix** trumps the competition when it comes to original content, movies, kid-friendly TV, and ad-free episodes. However, even though they have an extensive library of past seasons, they usually don't air episodes until the entire season is complete. Kind of a pain if you want to keep up with your favorite shows. That said, the movie selection is top-notch.
- **Hulu** is similar to Netflix in that they both stream TV shows and many movies. However, while Netflix waits until a season is over before airing, Hulu features shows the day after they go live. Most past seasons are available in the archives, but occasionally a channel (e.g., The CW) will have a separate contract and give them access only to the last five episodes. The only downside is the basic Hulu version features a few commercials, but they also offer an ad-free subscription for just a few dollars more per month.
- **Amazon Prime** isn't just for two-day shipping; this service also features hundreds of movies and shows that you can watch for free online with your subscription. From my experience with Prime, I didn't find the selection to be awesome for adults, but they do have a lot of kid-friendly movies and shows.
- **Sling TV** is the newbie on the cable alternative market, and so far, I'd say it's a winner. Sling streams through Dish Network, and carries live channels such as HGTV, ESPN, Food Network, Travel, DIY Network and more. Not only can you stream live, but you can also go back and start the current episode over, or watch any episode on that channel within the last 24 hours!

It's best to choose from the above services based on your personal preferences. If you have kids, you might want to go with Amazon Prime. If